DragonflEye

Researchers at the Charles Stark Draper Laboratory have somehow managed to turn a living dragonfly into a controllable drone. The trouble with drones is that the smaller they are, the harder it is to keep them powered for long periods of flight. Using an actual flying insect means you've (somewhat) bypassed that hurdle. They've placed tiny sensors on the dragonfly which allows it collect data and power the sensors with tiny solar cells also mounted on the dragonfly. For controls, they claim to have come up with a unique technology which allows them to steer the dragonfly. The dragonfly used for the project is genetically engineered with "steering neurons" in the insect's spinal cord. This allows researchers to control the dragonfly using pulses of light, delivered via optical structures more flexible than fibre optics. This approach supposedly doesn't affect or damage the dragonfly, but that doesn't mean that the ethics of the project aren't being questioned regardless.

Logitech Powerplay Mouse Pad

Logitech might have found the perfect solution to the problem of wireless mice running out of juice with the Powerplay mouse pad, which can charge your wireless mouse! The Powerplay bundle, which is how it's being packaged, will retail for around a $100 (₹6,400/- approx). The bundle will consist of a charging base, with two surfaces – hard and soft. Then you have the Powercore module. It plugs into Powerplay compatible mice which enables charging on the base. There will be two at launch, the G903 and G703. What we also know is that it works based on magnetic resonance power transfer. However, you usually require the object to remain stationary on a particular spot on the surface for that work. But Logitech says they've overcome this issue and that the mice will charge anywhere on the pad. Well, there's only one way to find out for sure!

MetaLimbs

A team from the Inami Hiyama Laboratory have come up with the MetaLimbs project, which is a pair of robotic doctor-octopus like arms which you can control with your feet. The project itself seems a bit silly on the surface but you never know.

How the MetaLimbs work is that you strap the tracking markers to your legs. The tracking markers go on your knees, feet, and toes, each representing the elbows, wrist, and hands on the MetaLimbs respectively. Furthermore,

there's even feedback – to an extent – so when something touches the MetaLimbs' hands while it's in use, you will feel it on your feet via a simple squeeze band. You would ideally use the MetaLimbs when seated or when your feet are otherwise unoccupied, for obvious reasons. There doesn't seem to be too many use-cases for the MetaLimbs as of yet, but it does open up room for a host of ideas for prosthetic limbs.

Intel Compute Card

Intel first unveiled their credit card sized PC, the Compute Card, at CES this year and they officially launched the Compute Card at Computex this year. They also announced a list of partners from whom we can expect to see the product. LG is making use of the Compute Card to turn their monitors into all-in-ones. Seneca and Foxconn on the other hand are utilizing the Compute Card for mini PCs. There's a wide use-case and you can expect to maybe even see the Compute Card in tablets and other interactive surfaces. We haven't yet seen what Intel's well-known partners, i.e, HP, Dell, Lenovo etc have planned for the Compute Card since they haven't shown their cards yet but Intel says that they're definitely working on something. Intel's Compute Card is expected to be out this August.